List: Authoring Guide

Audience: content authors and reviewers in AEM Universal Editor. Developers: see `blocks/list/README.md` and `docs/design/design-analysis.md`.

About the screenshots: they show the block as rendered in the local preview. The Universal Editor interface itself (Content Tree, Add menu, properties panel) can't be captured from this environment, so those steps are described in text. Numbered orange badges in the anatomy screenshots were added for this guide; they don't appear on the page.

Status: tested in the local preview at desktop, tablet and mobile widths. Still to confirm in your AEM author environment: List, Theme card and Insight card appearing under Add, and editing titles directly on the canvas.

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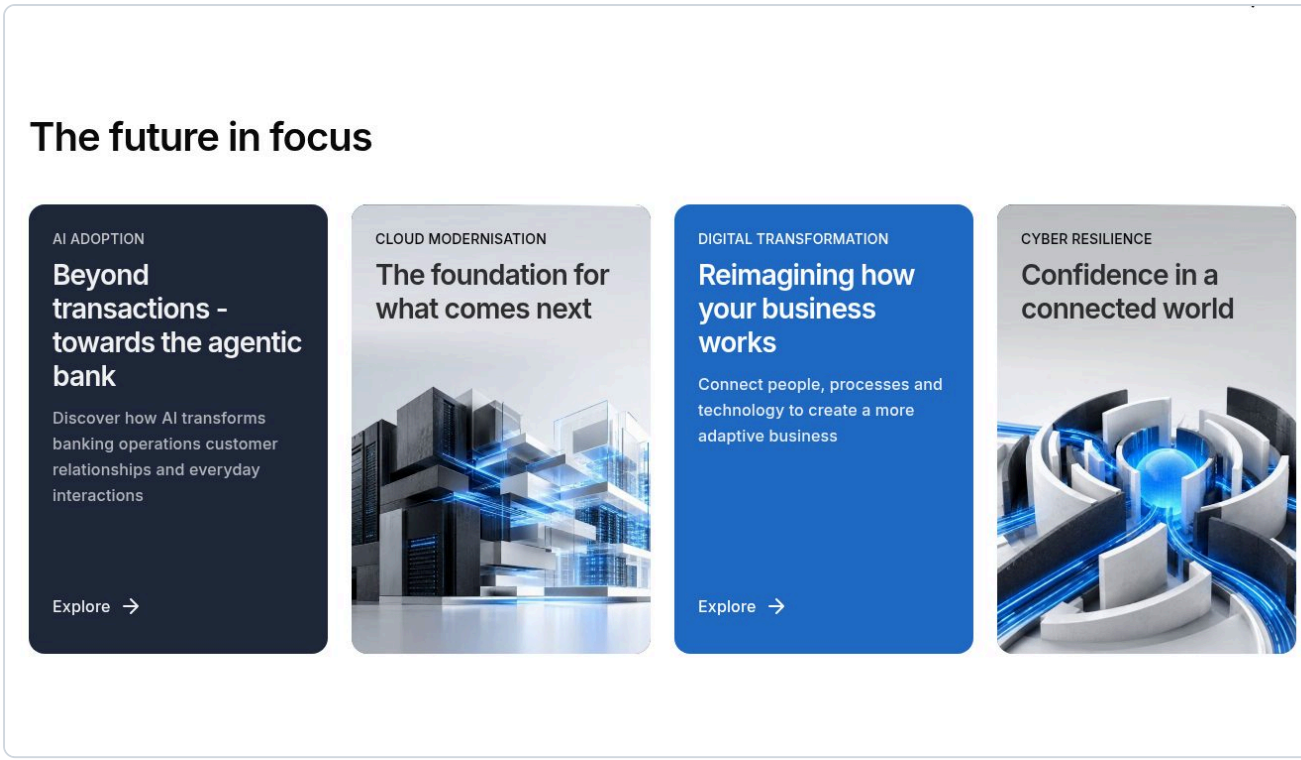
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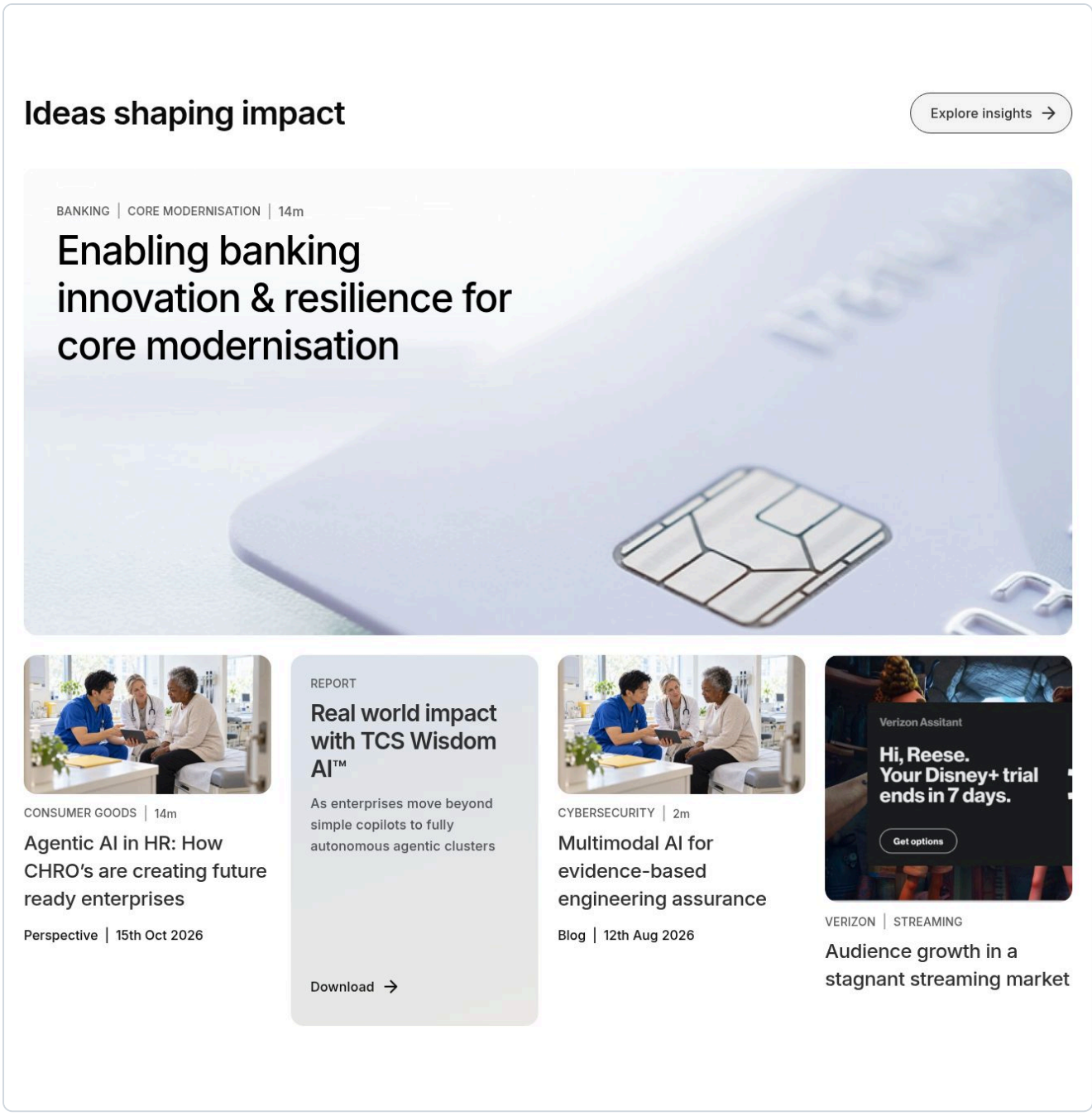
1. What the List block is

A **List** is a section heading, an optional link next to it, and a set of cards. It comes in two variations, taken from the Figma design:

Themes: a row of four theme cards.



Insights: a large featured card followed by supporting cards (articles, reports, case studies).




```
List                          ← the block: Variation, Heading, Header Link
├── Theme card / Insight card
├── Theme card / Insight card
└── …
```

Every card is clickable as a whole. Visitors don't have to hit the small link.

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2. Add a List

1. Open the page in **Universal Editor**.

2. In the Content Tree, select the **section** where the List should go. Any section works, including a tab inside a **Tabs** container.
3. Click **Add (+)** → **List**. It's added with the heading "Section heading" and no cards.
4. With **List** selected, choose the **Variation** and type the **Heading** (see section 3).
5. Select the List and click **Add (+)** → **Theme card** or **Insight card**, once per card.

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3. List settings

Select the **List** block and set:

Field	Notes
Variation	**Themes** or **Insights**. Defaults to Themes
Heading	Required, up to 80 characters, e.g. "The future in focus"
Header Link	Optional page or URL, e.g. the insights listing
Header Link Text	e.g. "Explore insights", up to 40 characters

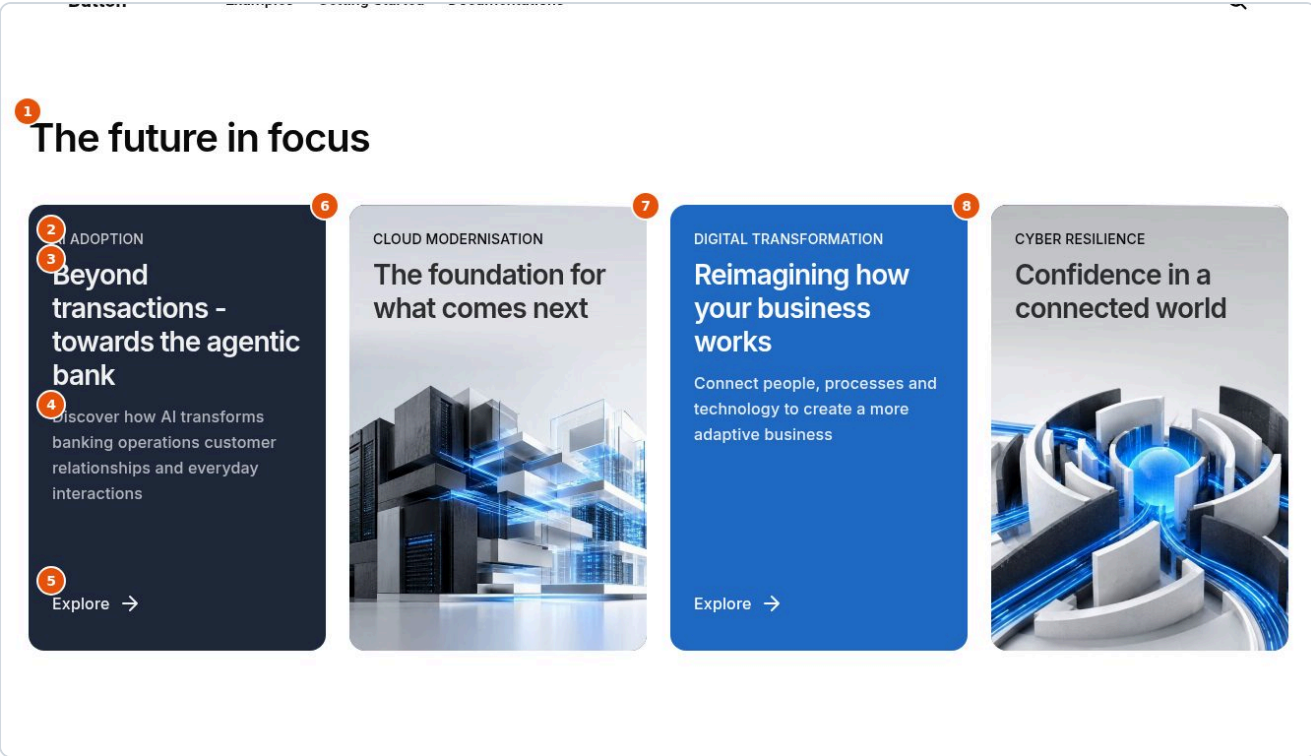
On desktop the header link is a rounded button to the right of the heading. On smaller screens it's a plain arrow link. Leave both header link fields empty to show only the heading.

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4. Themes variation

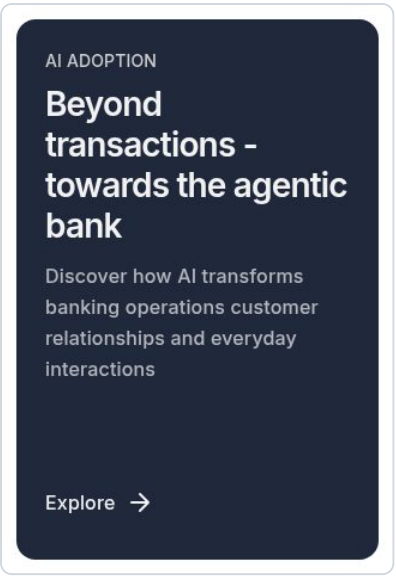
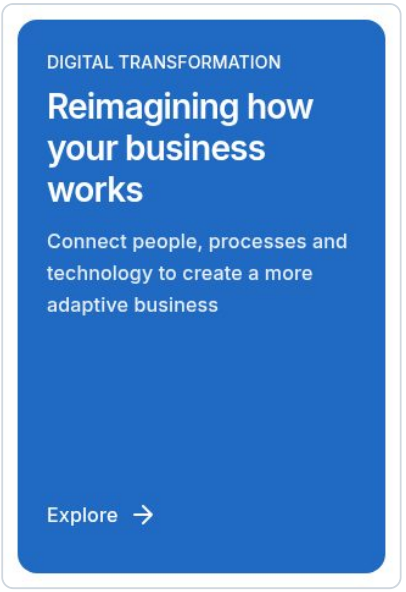
Use **Theme cards** in a Themes list. The design shows four.

Card anatomy



#	Field	Notes
1	Heading	Set on the List (section 3)
2	Eyebrow	Short label shown in capitals, e.g. "AI adoption" (up to 40 characters)
3	Title	Required, up to 90 characters. About 50 fits the design best
4	Description	Optional, up to 180 characters
5	Link + Link Text	The whole card links here. Link Text defaults to "Explore"
6	Card Colour: **Dark**	Used when the card has no background image
7	Background Image (+ Alt Text)	Turns the card into an image card with dark text
8	Card Colour: **Brand blue**	The second colour in the design

The three looks

Dark	Brand blue	Image
		

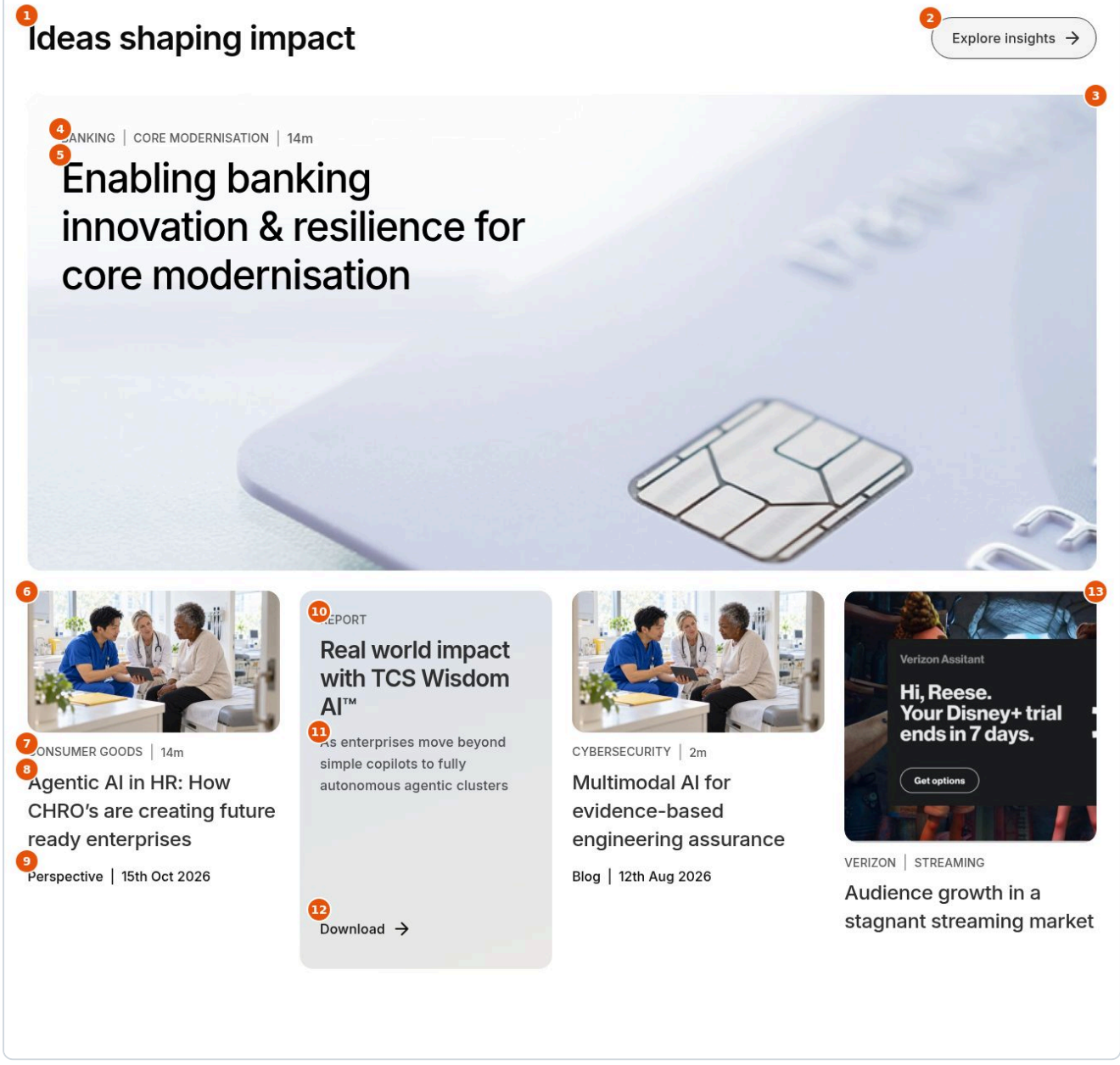
- **Without an image**, pick a **Card Colour**. The design alternates Dark and Brand blue.
- **With an image**, the colour setting is ignored, the text turns dark, and the "Explore" link is hidden; the title becomes the link instead. Choose images with a calm, light area at the top so the text stays readable.

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5. Insights variation

Use **Insight cards** in an Insights list. Set each card's **Card Type** first. It decides which fields are shown and how the card looks.

Card anatomy

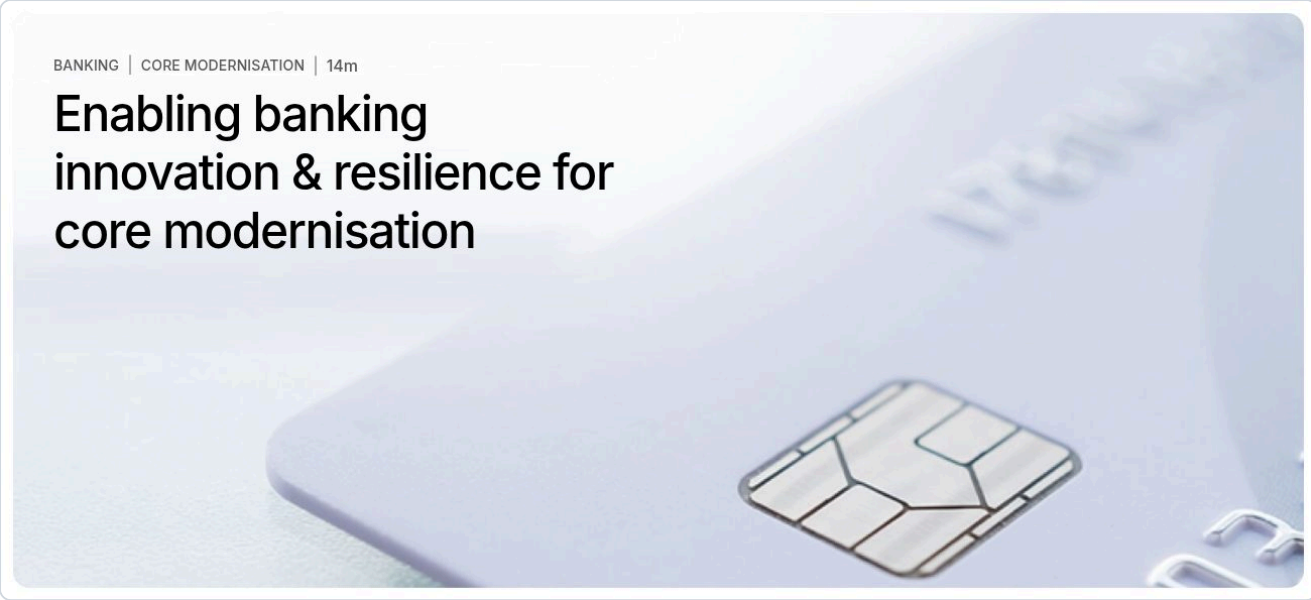


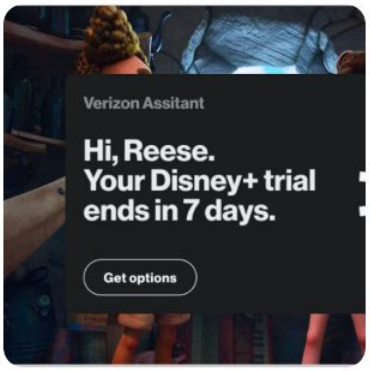
#	Field	Card types	Notes
1	Heading	–	Set on the List
2	Header Link + Text	–	Set on the List, e.g. "Explore insights"
3	Card Type: **Featured**	Featured	Full-width card, the image is the background
4	Tags + Read Time	Featured	Tags are comma separated, e.g. "Banking, Core modernisation". Read Time e.g. "14m"
5	Title	Featured	Required on every card type, up to 120 characters
6	Image (+ Alt Text)	Article, Case study, Featured	Not shown on Report cards
7	Tags + Read Time	Article	Shown above the title
8	Title	Article	The title is the card's link
9	Content Type + Date	Article	Footer line, e.g. "Perspective | 15th Oct 2026"
10	Tags	Report	Shown as the label, e.g. "Report"
11	Description	Report	Up to 180 characters
12	Link Text	Report	Visible link, e.g. "Download" (defaults to "Read more")
13	Card Type: **Case study**	Case study	Square image

Link (all types): the page the whole card opens. Only Report cards show the link text; on the others the title is the link.

Card types

Featured



Article	Report	Case study
 CONSUMER GOODS | 14m Agentic AI in HR: How CHRO's are creating future ready enterprises Perspective | 15th Oct 2026	REPORT Real world impact with TCS Wisdom AI™ As enterprises move beyond simple copilots to fully autonomous agentic clusters Download →	 VERIZON | STREAMING Audience growth in a stagnant streaming market

Card Type	Use for	Fill in
Featured	The lead story	Image, Tags, Read Time, Title, Link
Article	Blogs, perspectives	Image, Tags, Read Time, Title, Link, Content Type, Date
Report	Downloads, reports	Tags (e.g. "Report"), Title, Description, Link, Link Text
Case study	Client stories	Image, Tags (e.g. "Verizon, Streaming"), Title, Link

Recommended layout (as in the design): one **Featured** card first, then four supporting cards. A Featured card always takes a full row; supporting cards sit four per row on desktop and wrap to a new row after four.

Write dates exactly as they should appear, e.g. "15th Oct 2026". They're shown as typed.

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6. Reorder, duplicate and delete cards

I want to…	Do this
Reorder cards	Drag the card in the Content Tree
Duplicate a card	Duplicate it in the Content Tree, then change its text and image
Delete a card	Select it and delete it
Switch Themes ↔ Insights	Change **Variation** on the List. Then replace the cards with the matching card type (Theme cards for Themes, Insight cards for Insights)
Turn an Article into a Report	Change **Card Type**, then fill in Description and Link Text

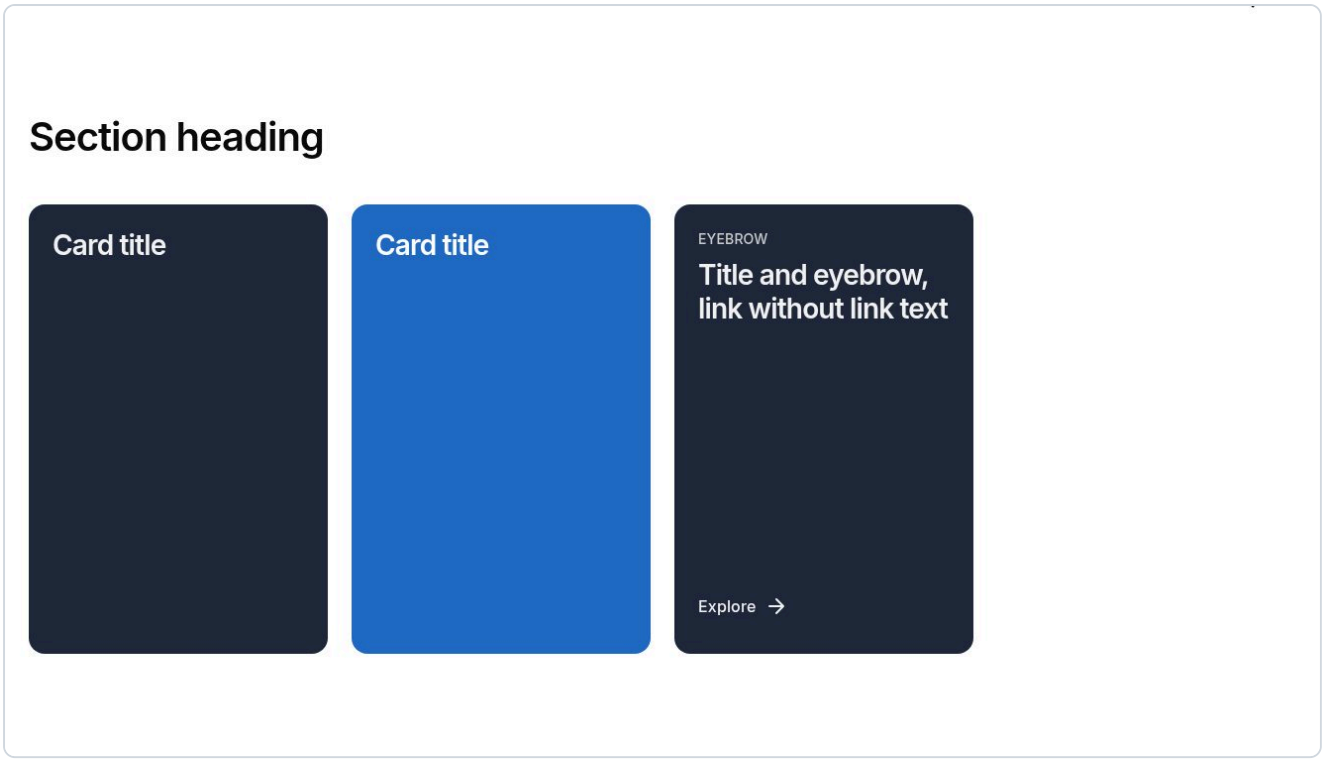
In the editor, clicking a card selects it for editing (the whole-card link only works on the published page). Edit a card's fields in the properties panel. Text such as titles can also be edited on the canvas.

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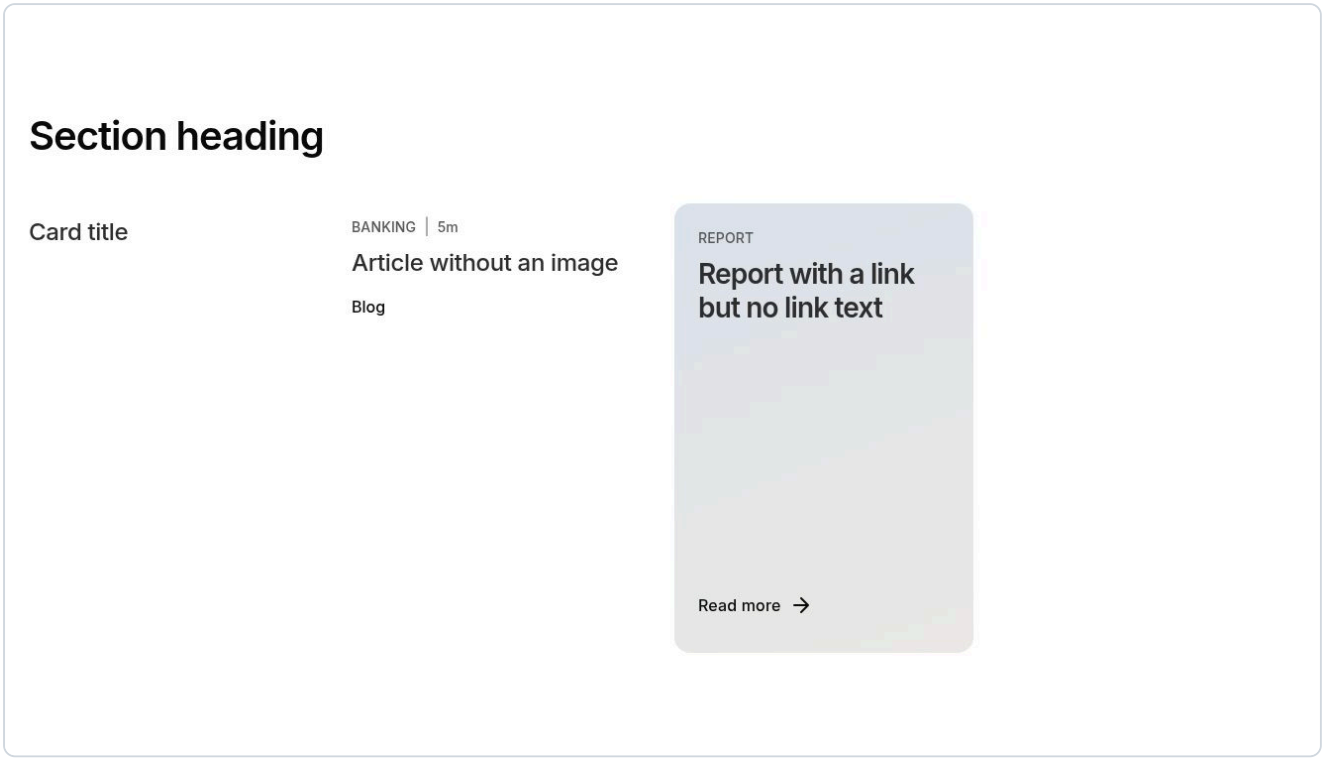
7. New and partly filled cards

New cards start with the title "Card title". Empty fields are simply left out, so a card never shows empty boxes or placeholder text.

Themes: a new Dark card, a new Brand blue card, and a card with a link but no link text ("Explore" is used):



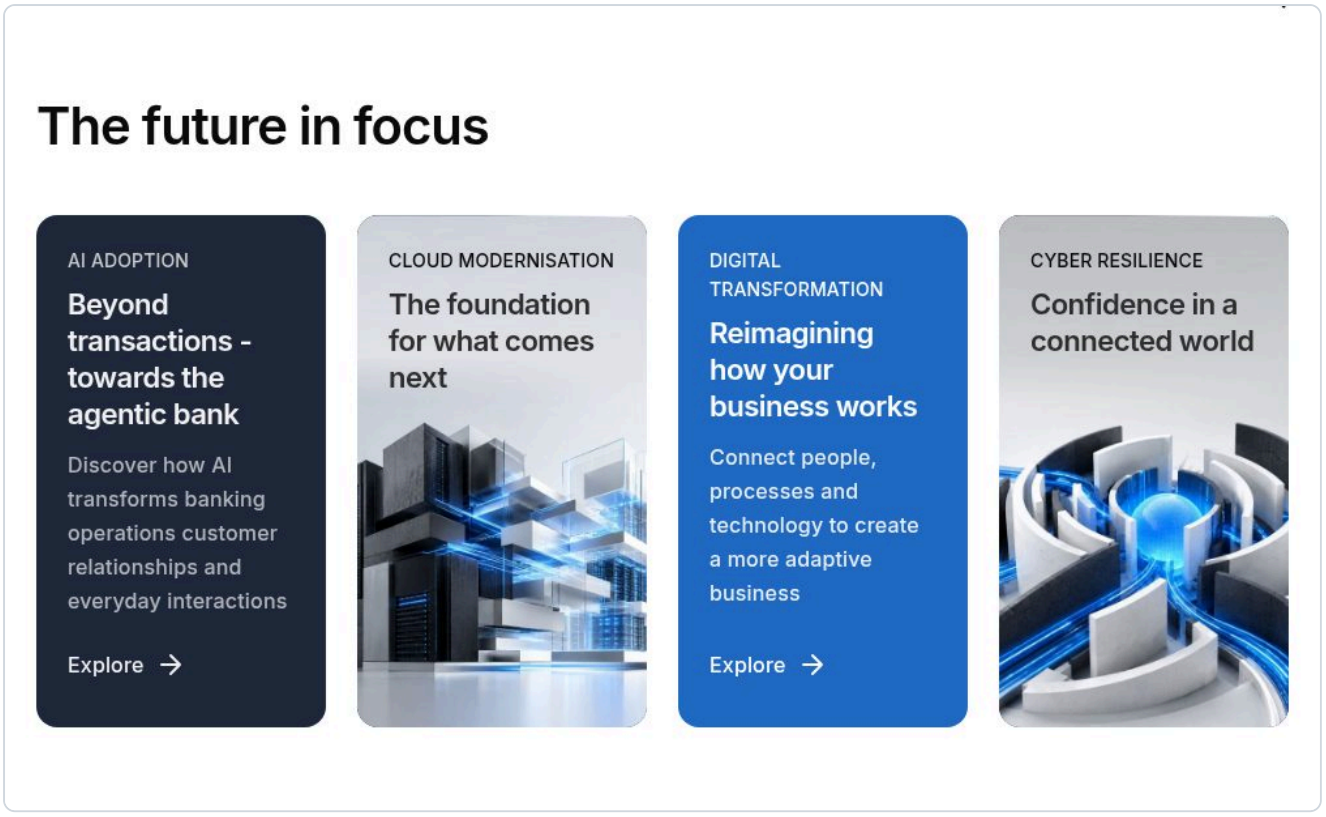
Insights: a new Article card, an Article without an image, and a Report with a link but no link text ("Read more" is used):

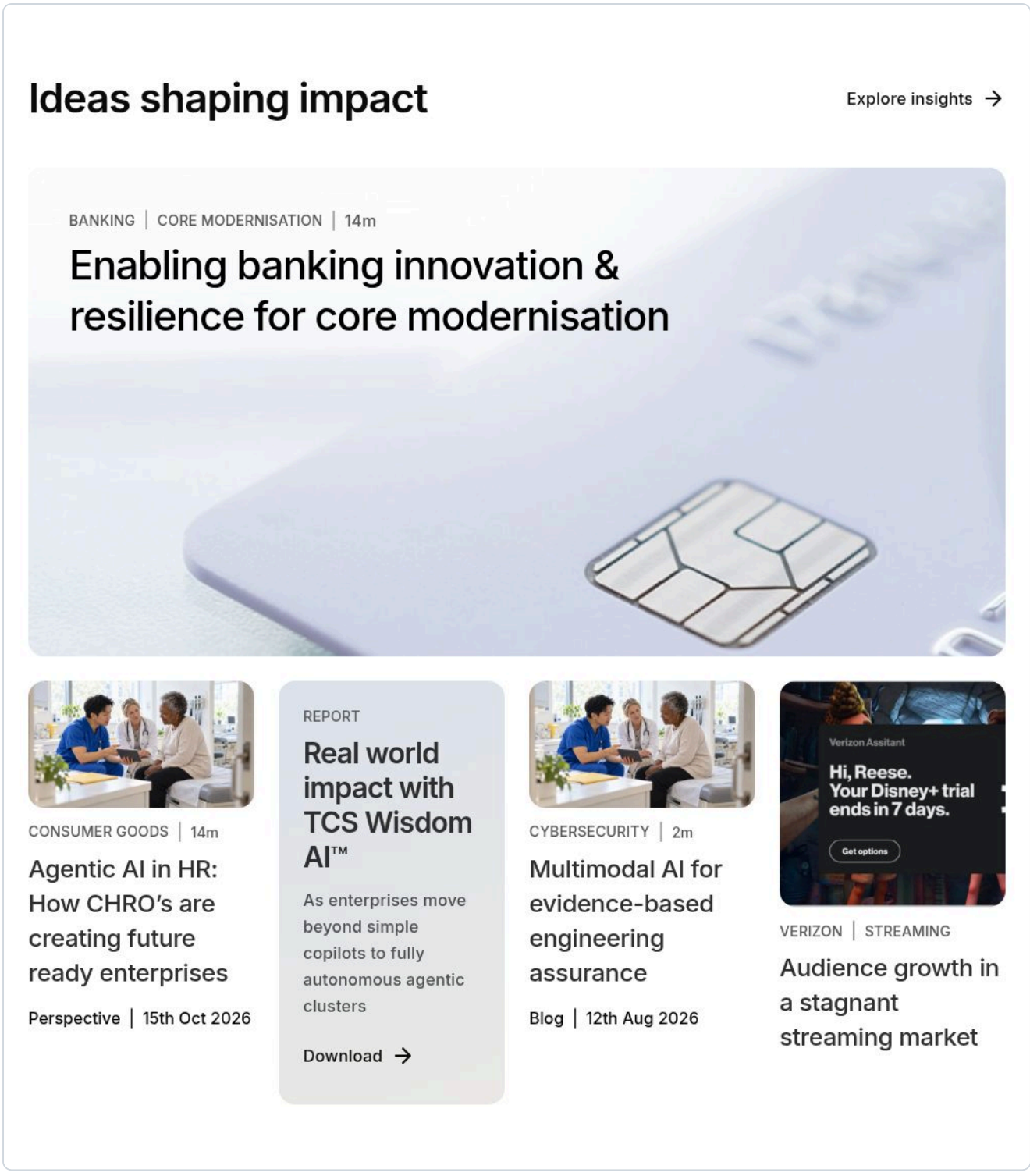


8. Tablet and mobile

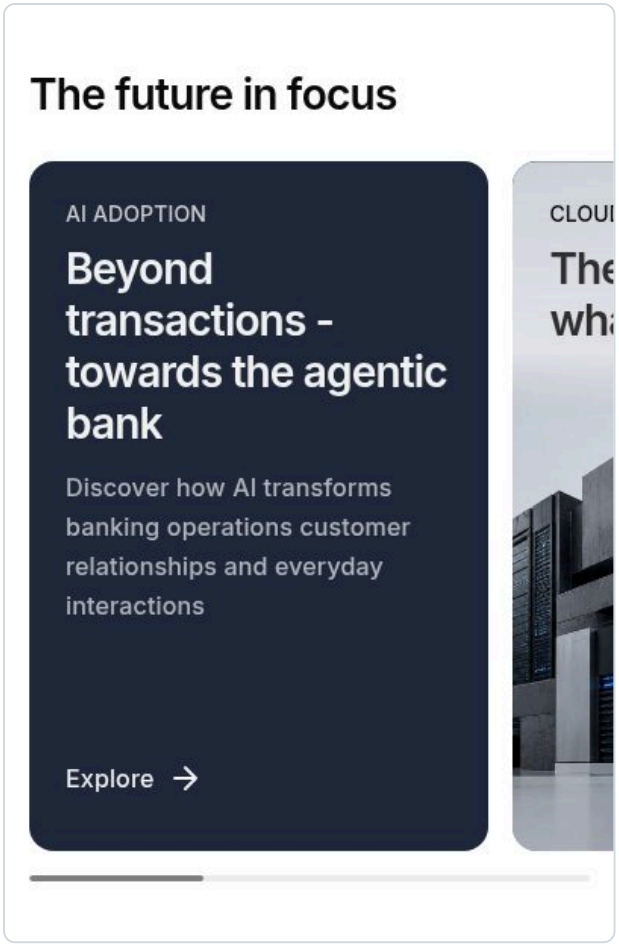
Nothing needs to be set for smaller screens. The List adapts on its own.

Tablet (landscape, as in the design): both variations keep four cards per row. Cards grow taller to fit their text. On narrower tablets (portrait), Themes cards swipe as on mobile and Insights cards sit two per row.

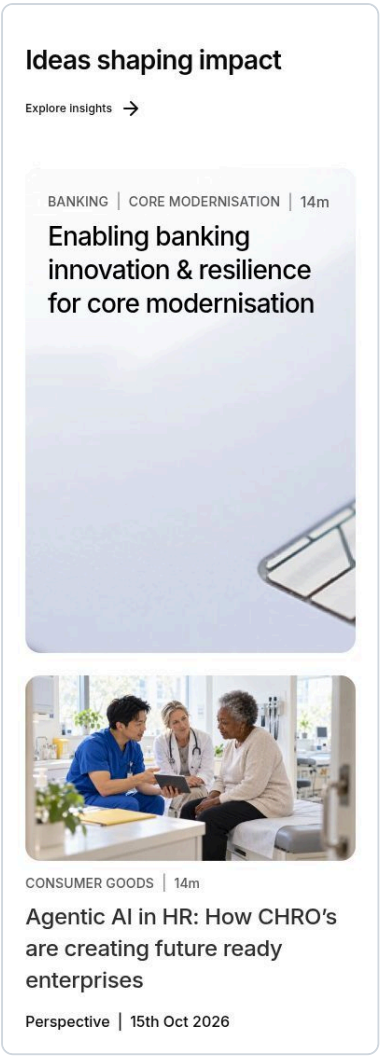
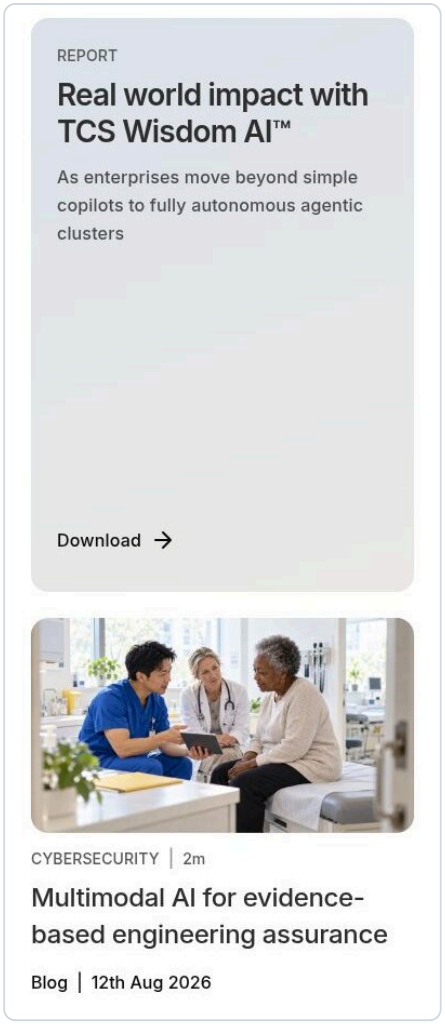
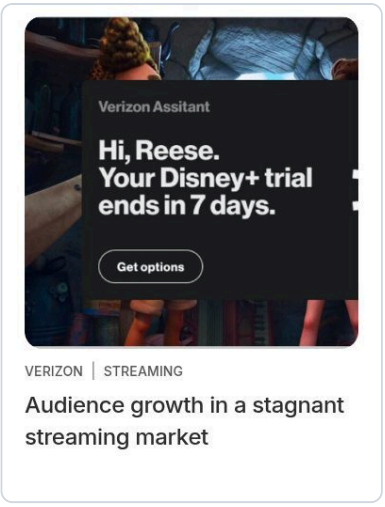




Mobile, Themes: the cards become a swipeable row. The bar below shows how far the visitor has swiped.

Start	After swiping
	

Mobile, Insights: cards stack in one column, and the header link moves below the heading.

Top	Continued	End
		

9. Accessibility checklist

Built in:

- The heading is announced as a heading, and each card title as a sub-heading.
- Cards are announced as a list ("list, 4 items").
- "Explore" and "Download" links are read together with the card title, so they make sense on their own.
- The "|" dividers are skipped by screen readers. Read time is announced as "Read time 14m".
- Keyboard users can tab through every card, with a visible blue outline around the whole card:



Authors should:

- Write a short, unique **Heading** and **Title** for every card.
- Add **Alt Text** for images that carry meaning (e.g. a product screen). Leave it empty for decorative images.
- Use images with a light, calm area behind the text on image cards and Featured cards.
- Write link text that says what happens, e.g. "Download" for a PDF report.

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10. Troubleshooting

Situation	What to do
List isn't in the Add menu	Select a **section** (not the page or another block) and click **Add (+)** again. If it's still missing, reload the editor
Theme card / **Insight card** isn't offered	Select the **List** block itself, then **Add (+)**
Cards look wrong for the variation	Theme cards belong in **Themes**, Insight cards in **Insights**. Check the List's **Variation**
The "Explore" link doesn't show	The card has a background image, so the title is the link. That's by design
The image doesn't show on a card	Report cards never show an image. Change **Card Type** to Article or Case study
A featured card isn't full width	Set its **Card Type** to **Featured**
Tags run together in one label	Separate tags with commas: "Banking, Core modernisation"
Text is hard to read on an image	Choose an image with a lighter area behind the text

To view the sandbox locally: `npx aem up --html-folder drafts --prefer-plain-html --port 3001`, then open `/drafts/list` (both variations) and `/drafts/list-states` (new and partly filled cards).